

November

18



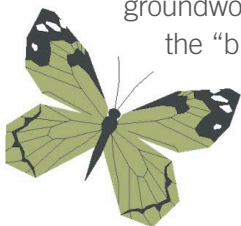
Butterfly effect

1962

US mathematician

Edward Lorenz wrote a paper that laid the groundwork for a theory that he later called the “butterfly effect”. It states that small

changes, such as the air moved by the flap of a butterfly’s wings, can start a chain of events that ends with something big happening, such as a tornado.



Born this day

1968 Owen Wilson, US actor. He starred in the *Night at the Museum* series, and voiced Lightning McQueen in the *Cars* animated films.

Battle of the Somme

1916

The Battle of the Somme, one of the major battles of World War I, ended after 140 days. It was one of the deadliest battles ever – more than 3 million soldiers died and about 1 million more were wounded.

1761

Telling time

British inventor John Harrison’s M4 marine chronometer finally cracked the longitude problem – the measure of how far east or west you are – after his son William tested the device on a voyage to Jamaica.



Also on this day

1803 Haitian revolutionaries inflicted a huge defeat on their colonial overlords, France. Haiti declared independence the following year.

1910 Suffragettes – women campaigning for the right to vote – were attacked at what the media later called the Black Friday protest.

2011 Minecraft was released. It went on to become the biggest-selling video game ever.

